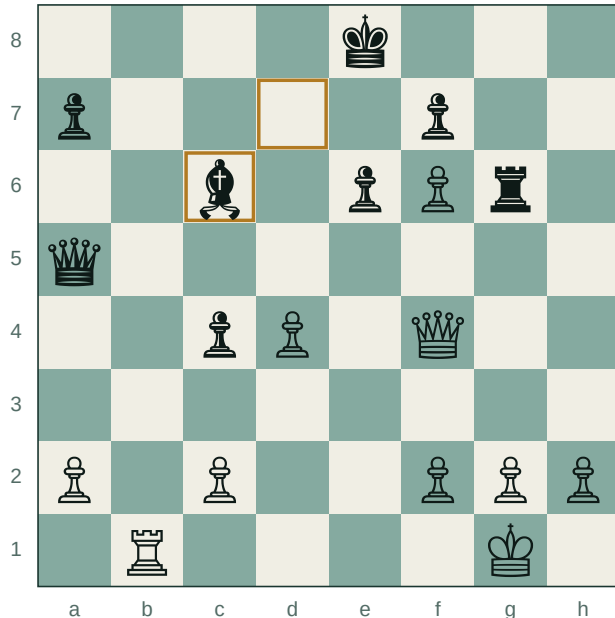


Active defensive resources: White, move 25

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 24...Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Qd6 Rxf2+ 26. Kf1 Rxf2+ 27. Kxf2 Qd2+ 28. Kf1

25.Qd6 The queen moves from f4 to d6. Recorded reply: **25...Rxf2+**.

26.Kf1 The king moves from g1 to f1. Recorded reply: **26...Rxf2+**.

27.Kxf2 The king captures the rook on f2. Recorded reply: **27...Qd2+**.

28.Kf1 The king moves from f2 to f1.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c6 and queen on a5. Check for tactical protection.